

# Amazon Workforce Planning

Primary Owner slx-all (LDAP)

Call to Action: To keep informed on Workforce Planning product progress and provide feedback, consider:

- Subscribing to the **WFP interest alias**: [subscribe \(wfp-interest@\)](#)
- Subscribing to the **WFP broadcast channel**: [WFP Broadcast](#)
- Accessing **WFP documents** (PRFAQ, MBRs, Prototype docs, etc.): [WFP-Interest-Library](#)
- Submitting **feedback**: [SIM - Create an issue](#)
- Asking product related **questions**: [wfp-support@amazon.com](mailto:wfp-support@amazon.com)

## What is Workforce Planning?

Amazon defines Workforce Planning (WFP) as an integrated mechanism that empowers leaders to make long-term decisions on the size, composition, and cost of their organizations. This includes (but is not limited to): integrating historically disparate decisions such as level mix, location, Early Career Talent (AUTA), and Level (L) 8+ talent movement into a comprehensive and consolidated capability.

WFP allows business leaders to model, plan, and evaluate workforce decisions in real-time, using embedded intelligence to guide them toward optimal talent decisions. This ensures Amazon has the right people in the right roles and locations to serve customers effectively.

The output of WFP is a Plan of Record, which associates job family, level, location and cost attributes with each Builder in Seat (BIS), backfill, and incremental growth headcount, ensuring that these decisions reconcile to the operating expenditures (OpEx) people cost targets.

## Components

### Plan Segmentation

Plan Segmentation exposes for business leaders the initiatives that lead to OpEx targets. Plan Segmentation allows for the systematic allocation of organizational resources into structured plans that enable effective workforce management. The new hierarchical approach establishes a framework where each leader maintains a unique plan that operates independently of cost center ownership constraints.

### Plan Builder

Plan Builder represents an assisted approach to workforce planning, breaking down complex decisions into manageable components while providing real-time insights and recommendations. At its core, the system guides leaders through four essential capabilities, each designed to support strategic decision-making.

Plan Builder includes a real-time tracking dashboard (Impact Summary) that ensures leaders stay informed of their progress toward OpEx targets throughout the planning process.

## Inspection

---

Inspection is an integrated and interactive mechanism that helps leaders make data-driven decisions while maintaining alignment with organizational objectives and financial targets. Inspection progresses from basic metrics tracking to provide actionable insights and ultimately suggests optimized alternatives.

## Operationalization

---

Operationalization ensures managers and support teams receive real-time guidance when implementing talent decisions, aligning them with the workforce plan. Leaders can control the appropriate levers for plan execution, allowing timely course corrections as needed. Leaders can enable automated organization-wide guardrails to guide managers making talent decisions (such as hiring and promotions) to de-risk the organization's workforce strategy.

## Users

---

### Business Leaders

---

The primary users of WFP are business leaders responsible for achieving business deliverables, meeting operating expense targets, and managing the workforce to support these objectives. They typically lead a sizable organization (~150 - 500 builders in seat (BIS)) and operate at organizational level (OL) 4/5.

Leaders with less sizable organizations or lower organizational levels may qualify to use WFP if they:

- Face significant growth or reduction.
- Operate with distinctly different characteristics compared to others within their organization, or anticipate substantial changes in core services or responsibilities.

### Other users

---

Other users of WFP include cross-functional teams that support business leaders: Finance, People Experience and Technology (PxT), Talent Acquisition (TA), and Business Operations Single Threaded Leader (STLs). These teams operate within the system to model scenarios, create plans, track execution, and ensure alignment with financial targets.

## Key stages

---

There are four key stages integrated in existing Finance-led 3 year plan (3YP), Operating plan one and two (OP1 & OP2), and Quarterly Guidance exercises. They are designed to respond to business needs and market dynamics.

Leaders can engage with any phase at any time, adapting their approach as circumstances require, whether managing organizational restructures, launching new services, winding down existing ones, or considering new location strategies.

1. **Assess:** for understanding the current position against future customer needs.
2. **Plan:** adapt to changing customer demands throughout the year.

3. **Operationalize:** runs continuously, translating strategies into action at the pace required to meet customer needs impact fully.
4. **Inspect:** woven throughout the entire process, enabling teams to monitor progress, identify trends, and make real-time adjustments.

## Beta launch (Plan Mapping: Dec. 1, 2025 | Plan Builder: Dec. 15, 2025)

---

### Data sources

---

The Beta release aligns to a single source of truth for two data sources:

1. **Financial Metrics**

Cost per Head by all headcount permutations by tenure, by cost center and the cascade of Operating expenditures (OpEx) people cost and headcount plans.

2. **People Metrics**

Builders in Seat (BIS) at year start, talent movement rates (attrition, transfers, promotions).

### High-level capabilities

---

The capabilities enable leaders to manage, edit, and publish workforce plans for Operating plan (OP) 2 '26 that do not exceed the Finance issued OpEx cost and headcount target.

- **Plan Builder**

Plan Builder guides business leaders through a workflow of step-by-step actions. The Beta release includes core planning modules that: 1) provide transparency to the OpEx target and annualized cost of start-of-year BIS, 2) enable actions that reduce the start-of-year BIS (YoY reductions, attrition, transfers out), 3) enable actions that add back remaining OpEx to the retained workforce (promotions, backfills, and YoY Growth), and 4) provide real-time tracking of actions taken and progress toward the leader's OpEx target.

After a leader is satisfied with a draft plan that does not exceed their OpEx target, they publish their plan of record for the OP2 '26 cycle. The system triggers a validation step, and output a finalized workforce plan. The plan includes a fully attributed headcount plan by month, and the ability to view the plan at both the organizational 'reports to' grain and at the cost center.

- **Scenario Planning**

Within each module in the Plan Builder, leaders can model actions in support of deprecating a team, project, or service, or implementing an innovation initiative. Leaders can also override talent movement assumptions, plan backfills, and allocate OpEx to new or expanded teams, projects, or services. The leader can assess potential outcomes in real-time before making decisions during the planning cycle and revisit throughout the year.

- **Finance Issued OpEx Targets**

Finance leaders currently communicate OpEx cost and headcount targets to business leaders, but a more systemic approach for WFP enhances both the initial target communication and the ongoing adjustment process as trade-off discussions evolve.

### Features

---

The release includes three features to support systemic target setting that are a prerequisite to planning:

- **Population mapping**

Integrate cost center data with reporting hierarchies. Leaders can view comprehensive workforce plans that include OpEx and headcount targets across their entire organizational scope, regardless of direct cost center ownership.

- **Segmentation**

Allow for a leader to segment their organization based on reporting hierarchies to reflect distinct services, projects, or teams. Each segment operates with its own workforce plan, complete with specific OpEx and headcount targets

- **Finance issued targets**

Leaders and their finance support can view the baseline cost of their workforce. Using this baseline plan, Finance leaders can then establish top-down targets. The Finance leaders can also establish targeted investment and reduction initiatives.

## Permission model

---

The release implements basic permission visibility features. More sophisticated features, such as UI-based permission management, automated relationship detection, and granular data access controls, are coming in future releases.

The Permission model begins with a configuration-based system supporting the Beta release group of org leader (OL) 4 leaders. It is a simplified model that eliminates the concept of secondary ownership in favor of single-owner accountability.

There are three key relationship types:

- **Plan Owner**

Plans are created at the OL 5 level, with OL4 leaders having flexibility in how they manage these plans. Access rights for OL4s depend on delegation choices (when retaining or delegating plan ownership as an OL4 or OL5).

- **Editor**

Typically Finance line leaders or other designated Business line representatives. Editors have universal read/write access to their assigned plans.

- **Viewer**

Includes a wide range of stakeholders such as Finance line leaders, Human resources business services (HRBS), Trusted Advisors (TA) Line Leaders, Org subject matter experts (SMEs), and others who need visibility into the plans. Viewers have read-only access and cannot modify plans.

## Prototype and pilot groups

---

For evaluating and testing launch capabilities (November 2025/OP2 '26 Plan) before a full Amazon-wide roll-out (March 2026/OP1 '27). The period of engagement is August through October 2025.

- **Prototype group**

Consists of subject matter experts and stakeholders deeply invested in WFP processes.

- **Pilot group**

Consists of business leaders that have experienced diverse operational challenges who can leverage these enhanced capabilities to drive impact and mitigate risks.

## Engagement after the Beta release

---

The Beta release establishes standard launch frameworks, including pre-launch communications, user acceptance testing, onboarding preparation activities (documentation, training videos, and FAQs), and dedicated technical support.

Leaders can continue to support WFP after the release by joining a Product Advisory Committee. The committee includes representatives from various business organizations [World Wide Amazon Stores (WWAS), General & Administrative (G&A), AWS, Devices, AIGC, and Entertainment] and cross-functional teams. Engaging with the group allows for continuing to align future prioritization of new features, support within organizations for the release for OP1 '27, and sharing of the long-term WFP roadmap and prioritization.

## MLP release (March 2026)

---

The Minimal Lovable Product (MLP) release aligns to the OP1 '27 planning cycle. It includes an end-to-end customer experience across Plan Building, Scenario Capabilities, Operationalization (Roster integration), and Inspection.

## Operationalization & Inspection releases (Q2 2026)

---

These two releases allow for support and monitoring of progress against plans developed by the Beta release.

Operationalization ensures talent decisions align with workforce plans through automated guardrails in Roster. Inspection provides an integrated Organizational Health dashboard with actionable insights on OpEx, headcount plans, workforce composition, and monthly run rates.

Focus of each release:

- **Operationalization**

The focus is on Roster and capabilities that ensure managers, and their support teams receive real-time guidance when acting on a Position ID (PID) to open a new position, transfer a position, or create a new requisition. When a leader publishes their plan of record, Roster automatically ingests and converts it into actionable guardrails and rules to ensure all activities remain within established thresholds.

- **Inspection**

The focus is on surfacing progress to OpEx people cost and headcount plans, workforce composition, and monthly run rates. It also can identify the five key action insights that could most significantly impact a leader's ability to achieve their financial and people plan.

## FAQs

---

### **Are there plans to deprecate any existing redundant solution after the Beta release and other future releases of WFP?**

A: There are plans to deprecate WWAS Geo-Talent Products & Strategy, as well as the AWS Workforce Planning point solutions, but only when replacement solutions are available that provide equal or enhanced capabilities compared to the current toolset. Amazon is committed to ensuring business continuity by maintaining existing tools until superior alternatives are fully implemented.

## Glossary

---



| <b>Workforce Planning Capabilities</b> | <b>Definition</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Plan Builder</b>                    | Guides business leaders through a workflow of step-by-step actions. Provides the foundational capability for business leaders to model and record their backfill decisions for job families, levels, and locations across both existing populations and net-new growth initiatives.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Operationalization</b>              | Ensures managers and support teams receive real-time guidance when implementing talent decisions and aligning them with the Workforce plan. Leaders control the appropriate levers for plan execution, allowing timely course corrects as needed. Leaders enable automated organization wide guardrails to guide managers making talent decisions (such as hires and promotions), to de-risk the organization's workforce strategy.                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Inspection</b>                      | An integrated organizational health dashboard that helps leaders make data-driven decisions while maintaining alignment with organizational objectives and financial targets. Inspection progresses from basic metrics tracking to provide actionable insights and ultimately suggests optimized alternatives.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Plan Segmentation</b>               | Allows for the systematic allocation of organizational resources into structured plans that enable effective workforce management. The hierarchical approach establishes a framework where each leader maintains a unique plan that operates independently of cost center ownership constraints.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>Business leader inputs</b>          | A feature for allowing Business leaders to define their target workforce composition against Job family and Job level inputs. This is a mandatory prerequisite to the planning process.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Scenarios</b>                       | Represents the overall modeling artifact where a Business leader selects specific Workforce planning (WFP) levers and defines planning actions to understand the impact on the planned headcount composition and Operational expenditures (OpEx) cost plans. Through scenario planning, Business leaders can model multiple "What-if actions" for their organization as they respond to emerging business needs and balance trade-offs against their headcount composition, organizational health and structure, and reconcile their OpEx cost plans. |
| <b>Plan of Record</b>                  | The finalized and published workforce plan for a specific planning period. The output of WFP that associates job family, level, location, and cost attributes with each Builder in Seat (BIS), backfill, and incremental growth headcount.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |

|                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Insights</b>                                                   | Identifies potential areas of concern within an individual WFP module, presenting them as actionable insights for leaders to review and inspect. When a leader selects the "Show Me How" associated with an insight, it creates a placeholder action in the Scenario Actions Builder. These placeholder actions require leader input to define specific changes and their associated headcount and financial impacts. The module focuses on surfacing what to inspect, rather than prescribing specific solutions. |
| <b>Alerts</b>                                                     | Feature that notifies leaders when their actions either fail to address identified risks or create new ones.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Recommendations</b>                                            | Feature that uses all knowledge of a business leader's organization from their historical data, current plan, insights, and intentions to identify specific focus areas and proposes a concrete action that addresses the risk without introducing new ones.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Start of year (SoY) Builders in seats (BIS) and Reductions</b> | A Plan Builder module. Demonstrates the Start of Year (SoY) Builders in seats (BIS) and a forecast annualized cost of that headcount as a planning baseline.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Attrition</b>                                                  | A Plan Builder module. Measures how many existing employees are exiting your organization. Leaders can see their historical attrition rates and make adjustment against yearly or monthly rates.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Transfers-out</b>                                              | A Plan Builder module. A historical rate of transfers out of an organization. When applied to a plan for the next year, the overall OpEx run rate for the year is reduced.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |